

Model Context Protocol

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GitHub [link is here](#)

How does MCP help?

The **Model Context Protocol (MCP)** is an [open standard](#) and [open-source framework](#) introduced by [Anthropic](#) in November 2024 to standardize the way [artificial intelligence](#) (AI) systems like [large language models](#) (LLMs) integrate and share data with external tools, systems, and data sources.^[1] MCP provides a standardized interface for reading files, executing functions, and handling contextual [prompts](#)

Without MCP, when you use a function call directly with an LLM API, you need to:

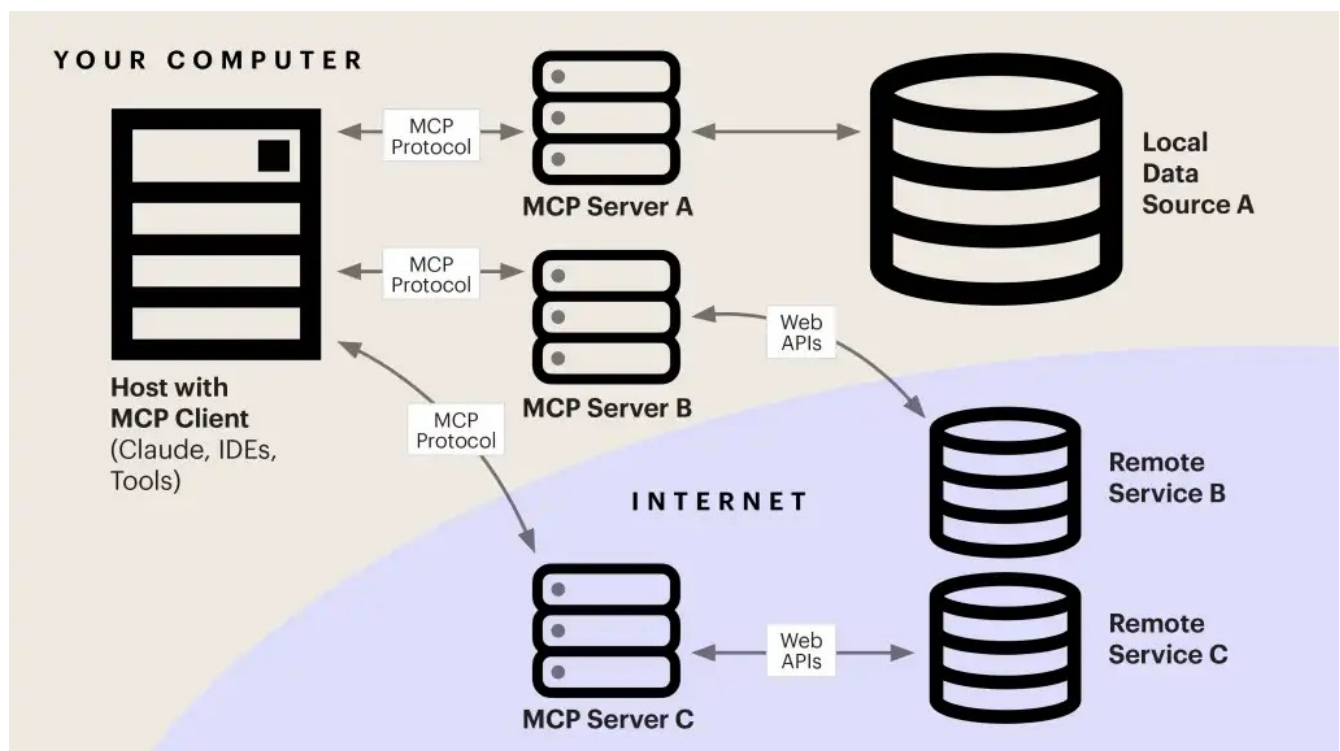
- ✱ Define model-specific function schemas, which are JSON descriptions of the function, acceptable parameters, and what it returns.
- ✱ Implement handlers (the actual code that executes when a function is called) for those functions.
- ✱ Create different implementations for each model you support.

MCP standardizes this process by:

- ✱ Defining a consistent way to specify tools (functions) across any AI system.
- ✱ Providing a protocol for discovering available tools and executing them.
- ✱ Creating a universal, plug-and-play format where any AI app can use any tool without custom integration code.

Key Features

- **Standardized Format:** MCP defines a shared schema for what “context” looks like (e.g., conversations, documents, past interactions).
- **Tool-Agnostic:** It is **not tied to any specific AI model or provider**, making it easier to integrate into any ecosystem (e.g., OpenAI, Anthropic, Hugging Face).
- **Composable:** You can plug in different memory systems, context providers, or agents as long as they follow the protocol.
- **Interoperability:** MCP enables smooth interactions between memory, retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) systems, agents, and LLMs.



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